have to move over snow fields and glaciers. In dangerous areas they use ropes to tie themselves in groups.

4. The climbers carry with them packs loaded with first-aid supplies, food and extra clothing for sudden changes of weather. They display spirit of sportsmanship and fellow-feeling and face the severe risks of life undaunted. Mountain climbing is a common sport in Europe. There are mountaineering clubs where training in mountaineering is imparted.

5. There are high peaks in India and there have been successful expeditions to scale these highest peaks. After the conquest of the Everest by Tenzing and Hillary in 1953, the Mountaineering Institute at Darjeeling was established to develop interest in mountain-climbing among the Indians. Expeditions have been sent to climb the highest peaks in the country.

6. Mountain climbing is a thrilling adventure. It brings into play the heroic qualities of humankind. Mountaineers deserve all praise for their courage and heroism. In recent years Mt. Everest has been scaled several times by foreign climbers. India too has organised several expeditions to Everest. Lately an Indian Sherpa scaled the Everest without the use of oxygen. Mrs. Bachchendri Pal also succeeded in scaling the Everest. She is the first Indian woman to do it.

DO YOU KNOW? A research team discovered in 1994 that Everest continues to grow approximately 4mm every year due to geological uplift.

L. Based on your reading, answer the following questions in a sentence or two.

1. Is mountaineering a dangerous sport? Why? *(para 1)*
2. What is frostbite? *(para 2)*
3. What are the qualities of a good climber? *(para 3)*
4. What do climbers carry with them? *(para 4)*
5. Where is the Mountaineering Institute situated in India? *(para 5)*
6. What qualities of humankind are brought out by this adventurous sport? *(para 6)*
7. Why do mountaineers deserve praise? *(para 6)*
8. What kind of visitors does Mt. Everest get? *(para 6)*

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